The Battle of White Mountain. Now look at the following two pictures, considered masterpieces of twentieth-century war art: *The War* (*Der Krieg*) by Otto Dix, and *That 2,000 Yard Stare* by Tom Lea.

Dix served as a sergeant in the German army during the First World War. Lea covered the Battle of Peleliu Island in 1944 for *Life* magazine. Whereas Walter and Snayers viewed war as a military and political phenomenon, and wanted us to know what happened in particular battles, Dix and Lea view war as an emotional phenomenon, and want us to know how it feels. They don't care about the genius of generals or about the tactical details of this or that battle. Dix's soldier might be in Verdun or Ypres or the Somme – it doesn't matter which, because war is hell everywhere. Lea's soldier just happens to be an American GI in Peleliu, but you could see exactly the same 2,000-yard stare on the face of a Japanese soldier in Iwo Jima, a German soldier in Stalingrad or a British soldier in Dunkirk.



Credit 1.36

36. Otto Dix, *The War* (1929–32).